

Yorgos Pantis

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Machine Learning

Nov. 2024 – Curr.

National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Dept. of Informatics and Telecommunications

- Research interests: reasoning in Transformers, Combinatorics, and Neural Networks theory
- Supervisor: Christos Tzamos
- Publications: **NeurIPS** (1), **ICLR** (1)

M.Sc. in Statistical Science

Oct. 2020 – Sep. 2021

University of Oxford, Dept. of Statistics, Lincoln College

- Thesis: *Authorship Attribution in Ancient Greek Texts*
- Supervisors: Yannis Assael, Yorgos Deligiannidis, and Thea Sommerschild
- Grade: **Merit**

B.Sc. in Mathematics

Sep. 2016 – Aug. 2020

University of Patras, Dept. of Mathematics

- Thesis: *Mathematical Techniques in Data Science and Machine Learning* – Grade: **10.00/10.00**
- Supervisor: Michael N. Vrahatis
- Grade: **8.90/10.00** (Distinction), equivalent to first-class honors (**top 1%**)

EXPERIENCE

Ph.D. Researcher

Jul. 2024 – Curr.

Archimedes, Athena Research Center

- Conducting theory-based research on reasoning in Transformer models and Neural Networks theory
- Supervisor: Christos Tzamos

Research Assistant

Mar. 2026 – May 2026

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Computer Science and AI Laboratory

- Investigating reliability and robustness properties in generative models
- Supervisor: Constantinos Daskalakis

Research Assistant

Apr. 2024 – Jun. 2024

Technical University of Denmark, Dept. of Applied Mathematics and Computer Science

- Explored Deep Learning theory via Riemannian geometry
- Supervisor: Georgios Arvanitidis

Research Assistant

Apr. 2023 – Dec. 2023

Czech Technical University in Prague, Faculty of Electrical Engineering

- Focused on the Mini-batch Stochastic Subgradient Projection method
- Supervisors: Vyacheslav Kungurtsev, Jakub Mareček

Research Assistant

Apr. 2022 – Mar. 2024

Athena Research Center, Institute for the Management of Information Systems

- Researched the interface of NLP, Privacy, and Security tasks using LLMs
- Supervisor: Constantinos Patsakis

Research Assistant

Oct. 2021 – Mar. 2022

Max Planck Institute for Mathematics in the Sciences

- Worked on authorship attribution focusing on Plutarch's texts using LLMs
- Supervisors: Ivan P. Yamshchikov, Jürgen Jost

PUBLICATIONS

C: Conference J: Journal †: equal contribution

- [C₃] *A Derandomization Framework for Structure Discovery: Applications in Neural Networks and Beyond*
Nikos Tsikouras, Yorgos Pantis, Ioannis Mitliagkas, Christos Tzamos. **ICLR 2026**
- [C₂[†]] *Teaching Transformers to Solve Combinatorial Problems through Efficient Trial & Error*
Panagiotis Giannoulis, Yorgos Pantis, Christos Tzamos. **NeurIPS 2025**
- [J₁] *The Anatomy of Deception: Measuring Technical and Human Factors of a Large-scale Phishing Campaign*
Anargyros Chrysanthou, Yorgos Pantis, Constantinos Patsakis. **Computers & Security 2024**
- [C₁] *BERT in Plutarch's Shadows*
Ivan P. Yamshchikov, Alexey Tikhonov, Yorgos Pantis, Charlotte Schubert, Jürgen Jost. **EMNLP 2022**

HONORS & AWARDS

- Full 4-Year Ph.D. Scholarship** Jul. 2024 – Curr.
Archimedes, Athena Research Center
- Competitive doctoral fellowship awarded based on academic excellence and research potential
- Gold Reviewer Award** May 2026
International Conference on Machine Learning
- Recognized for exceptional peer-review quality and service; included complimentary conference registration
- Research Infrastructure Grant** Dec. 2024 – May 2026
Greek Research & Technology Network
- Granted access to national high-performance computing infrastructure to support doctoral research
- Full Master's Scholarship** Oct. 2020 – Aug. 2021
Bodossaki Foundation
- Awarded for outstanding undergraduate academic performance to pursue a highly competitive master's program
- COVID-19 Assistance Fund** Jun. 2021
University of Oxford, Lincoln College
- Received financial support through a competitive student assistance program during the pandemic
- Vivian Green Student Assistance Scholarship** Feb. 2021
University of Oxford, Lincoln College
- Awarded in recognition of academic progress during master's studies
- Full 4-Year Undergraduate Scholarship** Sep. 2016 – Sep. 2020
Greek State Scholarships Foundation
- Scholarship awarded annually on the basis of academic excellence throughout undergraduate studies
- Consistently Ranked in the Top 1% of Cohort** Sep. 2016 – Aug. 2020
University of Patras, Department of Mathematics
- Maintained a top 1% class ranking throughout the entire bachelor's program
- Ranked 2nd Among Admitted Students** Sep. 2016
University of Patras, Department of Mathematics
- Placed 2nd among all students admitted to the Mathematics undergraduate program

TALKS & SERVICE

- Talks**
- Transformer Reasoning*
- Greek Stochastics π' Conference (Oral Presentation) Jul. 2026
 - Harvard University May 2026
 - Northeastern University May 2026
 - Boston University Apr. 2026
 - Massachusetts Institute of Technology Apr. 2026
 - HSBC Sep. 2025
 - Archimedes, Athena Research Center May 2025
- AI & Education Outreach*
- Greek Institute of Education Policy Jan. 2026
- Reviewing**
- NeurIPS, ICLR, ICML, TMLR 2025 – Curr.
- Teaching Assistant**
- National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Dept. of Informatics and Telecommunications*
- Computational Learning Theory Fall 2025
 - Artificial Intelligence II (Deep Learning for NLP) Fall 2025
- Volunteer**
- Archimedes, Athena Research Center*
- Organizing committee member for Greece's National AI Competition; preparing students for EOAI and IOAI